Common practice assessment for additionality
Supporting Document `IndigoCarbon_US-1_2023_0026a`

June 28, 2024

Contents

1 Background **1**

2 Constructing the Negative List **1**
2.1 Step 1 – Navigating the original Negative List 1
2.2 Step 2 – Evaluation of the project-specific means to modify the original Negative List 2
2.3 Step 3 – Approval of modified Negative List 2
2.4 Step 4 – Mapping of the modified Negative List to the Carbon program platforms (CPP) 2

3 Summary of Changes **3**

1 Background

Once an additional management practice change was identified on a field in the Carbon by Indigo Program (which were outlined in `Indigo_US-1_2023_0018` and `Indigo_US-1_2023_0024a`), the combination of the additional management practice change and the county (denoted as "PCxCounty") were evaluated through the common practice assessment. Specifically, the evaluation ensures that the PCxCounty in question is not on the Negative List. The Negative List contains combinations of practice changes and counties that must be excluded from crediting under the Soil Enrichment Protocol (SEP).

The Negative List is required to meet the criteria of the two-stage performance standard test, outlined in Section 3.4.1.1 of the SEP. To meet this criterion each field in the Carbon by Indigo Program was to be evaluated against the Negative List provided by CAR on the SEP landing page (under SEP additionality tool). However, with approval from CAR, the original Negative List was modified through the steps outlined below.

Note that if a grower stacks multiple practices and the respective field(s) are in a county where either one or both stacked practices are on the Negative List, then that grower ***will*** pass the common practice assessment as stacking would be eligible under Section 3.4.1.2 of the SEP.

2 Constructing the Negative List

The Negative List used by Indigo in this reporting period is a modification of the Negative List provided by CAR as mentioned above. This modified list has removed 60 PCxCounty combinations from the original list. The following steps provide a process flow for navigating the logic behind the list:

2.1 Step 1 – Navigating the original Negative List

The original Negative List including the list of PCxCounty combinations that were required to be excluded from eligibility is available on the SEP CAR landing page. Filtering on Column 7 to Ineligible will output the ineligible combinations for the SEP.

2.2 Step 2 – Evaluation of the project-specific means to modify the original Negative List

The original Negative List was evaluated following the procedure reported in `IndigoCarbon_US-1_2023_0024a`. The outcome of this evaluation was that 60 PCxCounty combinations were removed from the original Negative List, which can be found in either the supporting excel file of `IndigoCarbon_US-1_2023_0026b` under the Target Counties tab, or in the modified Negative List mentioned below. This document includes any data that may be relevant to the evaluation conducted for the modified Negative List.

The result of this process was the modified Negative List which was submitted to CAR for approval (as mentioned in Step 3). This modified Negative List can be found in `IndigoCarbon_US-1_2023_0026c`.

2.3 Step 3 – Approval of modified Negative List

CAR reviewed the request for the modified Negative List by Indigo and approved this request on April 30th, 2021. The file submitted by CAR to support this can be found in `IndigoCarbon_US-1_2023_0026d`.

Note that Nance, Nebraska was requested by Indigo to be removed from the Negative List but this request was denied by CAR; therefore, this county was removed from the list of 60 PCxCounty combinations. This has been reflected in the work below.

2.4 Step 4 – Mapping of the modified Negative List to the Carbon program platforms (CPP)

Key features required to implement aspects of the Negative List into Indigo's Platforms:

- **Mapping counties based on field centroids:** Indigo received approval from CAR to use the field centroid to assess against the Negative List (which can be found in `Indigo_US-1_2023_0067a`). Therefore, no measures were required to be taken to ensure that field boundaries did not overlap across county lines; however, checks were put in place to ensure that the location of the field centroid did not overlap across county lines.
- **Mapping CAR geocodes to FIPS:** The CAR county code (referred to as "geocodes") is not identical to the Federal Information Process System (FIPS), which is integrated in Indigo's Platforms. To accommodate this, the Engineering team used a mapping scheme between the CAR-provided geocode to FIPS. This mapping has been included in the modified Negative List.
- **Mapping CAR practice changes to Indigo practice changes:** The practice changes provided by CAR needed to be mapped to Indigo's internal practice change definitions. To accommodate this, the mapping scheme in table 1 was developed.

Table 1: Mapping of practice changes to negative practice change list

Negative List practice change	**Internal practice change definition**
Rotation or intensive grazing	Any practice change related to grazing: • Implement grazing • Increase the number of paddocks on the field
No-till	A reduction in the number of tillage passes resulting in the number of passes equal to zero
Reduced tillage	Any other practice change related to tillage (except the no-till practice change) • Reduce the number of tillage passes (where resulting number of passes is greater than zero) • Reduce the impact of tillage through tillage type • Reduce the impact of tillage by delaying first tillage event
Cover crops	Any practice change related to cover crops: • Planting a new cover crop • Adding a legume (new species) to an existing cover crop • Extending the length of the cover crop season

3 Summary of Changes

Section	Date	Summary of Changes
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